



A **VENDOR** is surrounded by produce at the Santa Monica Farmers Market last week. Grocery prices are up. GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

Measles hits U.S. record not seen since '91

California, meanwhile, has logged 52 cases so far this year, twice as many as in all of 2025.

By RONG-GONG LIN II

Measles cases have hit a record in the United States not seen since 1991, nearly a decade before the viral disease was declared eliminated.

Cases in California have also swung upward — with twice as many so far this year as in all of last year. Health officials from Los Angeles to San Francisco have been scrambling to respond to measles cases as they emerge, hoping to keep a lid on new infections from travelers before they have a chance to spread.

The grim milestone nationally comes amid a generational setback in controlling the highly contagious disease, which prior to the vaccine era caused millions of infections a year and annually left 400 to 500 people dead, 1,000 with swelling of the brain, and 48,000 needing hospitalization.

Last year, the U.S. recorded three measles deaths: Two victims were unvaccinated school-age children in Texas and one was an unvaccinated adult in New Mexico. They were the first measles deaths in the U.S. since 2015, and the first among children since 2003.

So far this year, there have been 2,318 measles cases reported nationwide, according to the U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. [See **Measles**, A7]

Soaring oil prices add new pocketbook stress

Gas, groceries and more to rise as war revives

By CATHY BUSSEWITZ, MAE ANDERSON AND ANNE D'INNOCENZIO

Already feeling pinched since the start of the Iran war, consumers are likely to feel more pain ahead as oil prices pushed past \$100 a barrel Thursday amid renewed fighting and military strikes that have left global oil supplies stranded in the Middle East.

The elevated price marked a turn from lower oil prices enjoyed briefly when hostilities between the U.S. and Iran waned in June. Brent crude, the international standard, last reached \$100 a barrel in May.

Companies that produce and sell fresh food, school supplies and anything that gets shipped using fuel reported cost impacts from an earlier spike in energy prices after the U.S. and Israel attacked Iran. They're likely to continue passing some of their increased expenses to consumers.

"Since everything relies on petroleum in our economy, for good or ill, if the cost of petroleum goes up, then everything else goes up as well," said Joe Adamski, a managing director at procurement services company ProcureAbility.

Here's how higher oil prices could put more strain on the finances of U.S. consumers:

Gasoline prices return to \$4

Volatility along the Strait of Hormuz and broader regional instability pushed up the price of crude oil, the main ingredient in gasoline, and could continue to make driving costlier during the second half of summer, according to the American Automobile Assn.

The U.S. price for regular gasoline averaged \$4.10 a gallon Friday, 12 cents more than a week ago, and drivers in most states were paying \$4 or more, according to AAA.

"Given the typical lag along the oil industry's supply chain, prices at the pump are poised to keep rising at least into next week," said [See **Oil**, A11]

TARIFFS: Levies over forced-labor claims irk trade partners. **WORLD, A2**

L.A. nonprofit theaters ponder a new way forward

He said the quiet part out loud. As the artistic director of New York's Public Theater and one of the art form's most prominent leaders, Oscar Eustis is known to do that. And as always, he got the art world talking.

When Eustis, 67, announced Wednesday that he would step down from his role at the Public in 2028 — after 23 years — he said in a New York Times interview that "the American nonprofit theater movement is over." This has been whispered about and lamented since the COVID-19 pandemic led to temporary theater closures across the country

Spurred by a bleak national forecast, leaders from three local stages say the industry must reinvent itself

By Jessica Gelt

that have since become permanent, but it is rare to hear it expressed so candidly.

Did Eustis, one of the key players in that vaunted movement — the man who helped foster "Hamilton" — really mean what he said? And if so, how does theater move on in the face of obstacles that at times feel as though they are scattered across an increasingly difficult course? In a wide-ranging follow-up interview with the Los Angeles Times, Eustis addressed the path forward.

It's not an easy one, but Los Angeles theater leaders [See **Theater**, A9]

Coaster sounds a little too 'Fast & Furious'

Leonard R. Garner Jr. loves roller coasters. And the mostly retired television director and actor has a place in his heart for Universal Studios Hollywood, the theme park atop the studio where he spent many days behind a camera.

He also adores the tranquility of his home. As a resident of Toluca Lake, the tiny neighborhood nestled below the Wizarding World of Harry Potter, Super Nintendo World and other park staples, Garner watched with curiosity as Universal Studios began erecting Fast & Furious: Hollywood Drift, its new outdoor, high-speed thrill ride. He continued to track the construction over the next three or four years while out on afternoon walks.

At last, when Universal

Residents of Toluca Lake aren't pleased with new, noisy neighbor

By Todd Martens



A **VIEW** of Universal Studios Hollywood's "Fast & Furious" ride, which is now running with test riders. KAYLA BARTKOWSKI Los Angeles Times

Studios began testing the ride this spring, Garner breathed a sigh of relief. "I was amazed at how quiet it was," he said. "I could not hear it at all."

But he wasn't considering one detail: There were no people on it.

Everything changed, Garner and numerous other Toluca Lake residents said, the summer day when Universal Studios began running the coaster with a full slate of test riders. There were screams. They were loud — piercing even double-paned windows. And they were constant.

"Disturbing," said one resident, Dr. Christopher Zito.

"You think something is happening," said Patrick Nazari, another resident. [See **Universal**, A9]

Paramount agrees to long delay in merger

Concession in states' antitrust case may push its Warner Bros. deal to next June.

By MEG JAMES

Paramount Skydance has agreed to delay its purchase of Warner Bros. Discovery to as late as next June as David Ellison's media company mounts its defense to the antitrust challenge brought by California Atty. Gen. Rob Bonta and his coalition of 11 other state attorneys general.

The major concession comes as Paramount was facing an Aug. 3 hearing to try to convince U.S. District Judge Araceli Martínez-Olguín that its proposed \$11-billion deal — which would reshape Hollywood with the combination of two historic studios — would not violate U.S. antitrust laws.

The judge appeared to be leaning toward the arguments of the state attorneys general, who have alleged that the proposed union of two big film studios and television networks including HBO, CBS, CNN, Comedy

Central, Nickelodeon and TBS, runs afoul of the 112-year-old Clayton Antitrust Act.

In a stipulation filed Friday, Paramount said it would hold off on closing its blockbuster purchase until after the states' antitrust case can be decided in a trial before the Oakland-based judge or by June 1, 2027, whichever date comes first.

The move came after Martínez-Olguín issued a temporary restraining order earlier in the week — requested by Bonta and the others — which paused the deal until next month's preliminary injunction hearing, when she was set to decide whether a lengthy moratorium should be imposed.

Privately, Paramount officials were worried they might lose that round before Martínez-Olguín, so, during negotiations with the states, Paramount stipulated that it would not close the deal on its preferred timetable.

Paramount had wanted to finalize the takeover this month — or at least have it wrapped up by Sept. 30.

In a statement, Bonta celebrated the delay as "great news for audiences, [See **Paramount**, A11]

U.S. punished acts of protest, suit says

Homeland Security is accused of surveilling observers and yanking TSA clearance status.

By BRITTNY MEJIA

April Walker, a San Diego resident, was observing federal immigration agents in a Target parking lot in April when she said they boxed her in and pointed a camera at her face and license plate.

She said she never provided her driver's license and the agents only moved their vehicles and allowed her to leave after she called 911. Five days later, she learned that her Global Entry, which provides expedited TSA screening, had been revoked. It was only reinstated, she said, after she contacted a reporter who then reached out to the Department of Homeland Security to inquire about the revocation.

Walker laid out her story in a federal lawsuit, filed Friday in the Southern District of California, alleging that agents working for Homeland Security deployed facial recognition technology and license plate information to surveil people observing and documenting federal immigration enforcement. Homeland Security then used that information to revoke Global Entry privileges in retaliation, the lawsuit alleges.

"Now more than ever, those of us who have the privilege to speak out have a responsibility to defend the rights of everyone in our communities," Walker said in a statement. "When people are punished for exercising their First Amendment rights, we begin losing the democratic principles that protect all of us. Every American should be alarmed by retaliatory action against one's free speech."

In a statement, a spokesperson for U.S. Customs and Border Protection said, "Global Entry or other CBP Trusted Traveler Program memberships are not revoked because someone exercises their First Amendment rights."

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JAMES PICKS 76ERS

Calling it his "last decision," LeBron James announces that he will sign with Philadelphia to play in his record 24th NBA season. **SPORTS, B12**

On the hunt for cyclosporiasis

As experts explain how officials investigate foodborne illnesses, four more states report an outbreak. **NATION, A5**

Weather

Sunny and warm. L.A. Basin: 90/69. **B8**

Markets **A12**

Opinion Voices **A13**

AI 'psychopaths' raise alarm bells

Maybe it's not a great idea to create powerful models, Anita Chabria writes. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

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